

Tafseer Surah Asr- Surah Tin Exam 2 Study Guide

Surah Asr

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 103

Order of Revelation: 13

Number of Ayahs: 3

Theme and Subject Matter: Importance of time, qualities of the successful people

Connection between Surah Takathur and Surah Asr

- Surah Takathur speaks about humans going into excessive vanity because of their competition
- Surah Asr builds off of this by saying, "You are losing out on time because of *takathur*. Don't think because of what you have achieved due to *takathur* you are not at loss."
- Takathur is **warning** you but Asr is **jolting you awake**.

[1] "By time"

- This is the last oath in the Quran
- *Second meaning*: Oath by time of Asr salah specifically
 - Asr time is very short especially for Hanafis
 - Your day/life is coming to an end
 - "I'm swearing by the time you have left on this earth."
- *Third meaning*: Squeeze; time is squeezing you until you have nothing left to give on the DOJ
 - Dunya is so suffocating that you don't have time for akhirah matters

[2] "Indeed mankind is in loss."

- Three forms of emphasis: *إن* , *Insaan* beginning with *ال* , and *ل* having a *fatha* (with a *kasra* is *harf jarr*) → essentially the ayah can be translated as, "Verily, indeed, the human being as a whole is in loss."
- Allah does not say " *الخسر* " - He says *في* ...
 - Meaning every human is in **some** kind of loss; missing out on dunya to achieve higher reward in akhirah does not count as "loss."

[3] "Except for those who have believed and done righteous deeds and advised each other to truth and advised each other to patience."

- *ءامنوا* : Those who have believed
 - This is the first ni'mah we have
- *عملوا الصالحات* : Done righteous good deeds (to prove our iman)
 - The deed itself will make you righteous; you will not reach righteousness until you act
 - *فعل* means to **complete** the deed, not just begin it or *عمل*
 - Beauty of obedience is that we don't always need to know the why; just obey
- *وتواصوا بالحق* : Advise one another to the truth (with sincerity)
 - From root word of *وصي* → when a father or mother is passing away and giving their final advice to child
 - Also how you distribute wealth; final command
- The *ت* at the beginning of *وتواصوا* means "continuously"

- Continuously give advice but with proper adab and in private
- حق : Absolute truth
 - You don't only advise people to your way/madhab

Final points

- Conditions for someone giving you naseeha
 1. Someone who loves you
 2. Someone with experience in that matter
 3. Someone who has taqwa and fear of Allah

Surah Humazah

Connection with previous surahs

- Surah Takathur speaks about distractions, Surah Asr is about time being gone.
- Surah Humazah tells us that we kill time by being around the wrong company and by being so invested in our wealth

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 104

Order of Revelation: 32

Number of Ayahs: 9

Theme and Subject Matter: Materialism and those who hoard money, how bad mankind can get into loss, severe and harsh descriptions of hell

Background of this surah

- Poor sahabah like Bilal (RA) and Suhail (RA) would enter a room and *kuffaar* would make a face

[1] "Woe to every scorner and mocker"

- ويل
 1. Woe; highest form of regret
 - a. Used for people in akhirah, not dunya
 2. Deepest valley in Jahannum
- لكل is referring to everyone
- لَمَزَ and هَمَزَ are both are degrading other people and come from arrogance
 - One opinion is that *humaza* is "when a person makes you feel unwelcome and less than them by their facial and body language," while *lumaza* is pointing at someone to make fun of them; gesturing with your hands
 - *Humaza* is when Aisha RA did the hand gesture to show the height of the lady she was talking about; *humaza* is more subtle
 - Another opinion is that *humaza* is backbiting, while *lumaza* is talking smack to someone's face
- Our intention for معاملات (dealings) does not matter, only how the other person feels

[2] "Who collects wealth and (continuously) counts it."

- The word جمع being used meaning "to gather," rather than كسب meaning "to earn."
- Indicating the money was attained through unlawful measures too; from orphans etc

- Ibn Abbas said جمع cannot be used for someone who pays zakah

[3] "He thinks that his wealth will make him immortal."

[4] "No! He will surely be thrown into the Crusher."

- حطمة means the Fire will crush a person and engulf them
- نبيذ : Meat pieces and food you throw away that you can't eat because it is dirty

[5] "And what can make you know what the Crusher is?"

[6] "It is the fire of Allah fueled."

- Ibn Abbas says this is one of the scariest ayahs because Allah refers to it as "His Fire"
 - Mudhaaf, mudhaaf ilayh
- Anything belonging to Allah is great

[7] "Which mounts directed at the hearts."

- It will destroy all diseases like *hasad* and arrogance
- طلع : Suddenly emerge
 - Physically crush the hearts OR every desire of the heart will be crushed

[8] "Indeed, Hellfire will be closed down upon them."

- مؤصدة : A covering with no escape

[9] "In extended columns."

- ممددة : Columns all the way up and down

Surah Takathur

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 102

Order of Revelation: 16

Number of Ayahs: 8

Theme and Subject Matter: Being busy with and competing for this world and forgetting the akhirah

Connection with previous surahs

- Surah Adiyat and Surah Takathur : "Time is running out" meaning there is still a little bit of time
- Surah Zalzalah and Surah Qariah : "Time is up"
- All four of these are a build up to Surah Asr where Allah takes an oath by time

[1] "Competition in (wordly) increase diverts you"

- الهيا is a verb meaning "puts you **in** distraction"
 - Even if you think you won't be affected, you are so immersed in dunya competition that you will be
- له : Wasting time; superficial things we spend time on

- “Everything that occupies your mind and time” from that which is more relevant at the time. Shaytan is an expert at taking us away from the most important thing to something slightly less important
- Not about haram and halal; it is a matter of personal situations
 - By default, له does not have benefit; there may be benefit depending on situation
- Nawaafil cannot take precedence over fard/responsibilities
 - *Example:* Do not fast on Mon/Thur if you know you’ll sleep through seekers!
- It is scary that Allah does not say ألهاكم الحرام ; no mention of haram in this ayah
 - We are diverted from permissible things
- Why does له happen? → التكاثر : **competition**
- Five stages of human life (all of these can have overlap but these are general ballpark estimates)
 1. لعب → Children mostly
 - a. Has actual benefit (sports etc) but can become له
 2. له → Being frivolous; age 9 - 14/16 ish
 3. زينة → Focusing on looking good; age 15 - 35/40 ish
 - a. Doing everything to show off and be recognized
 4. تفاخر → To pretend/status; age 40s to 50s
 - a. Follows scale of تفاعل - to fake
 - i. Meaning to fake your status
 5. تكاثر → Competing with yourself; age 50s-60s+
 - a. Find joy in bragging about wealth and children
 - i. By default, not haram; only if it is in an arrogant way

[2] “Until you visit the graveyards.”

- No one’s spirituality is so great that they don’t need to visit graveyards regularly
- Etiquette of janazah is to not delay any part of it; don’t add bid’aa to it

[3] “When you leave, you will definitely know the truth.”

- كلا used 3 times to show that disbelievers are being proven wrong
- As the senses of dunya decay, the veil of akhira is slightly lifted

[4] “Then no! You are going to know.”

[5] “No! If only you knew with knowledge of certainty.”

[6] “You will surely see the Hereafter.”

Recap of Surah Takathur

- علم اليقين : Know with certainty
 - Increases with age
 - “Cool, it’s snowing outside” without having to see it
 - For **believers**
 - People of Gaza act with such yaqeen, it is as if they have already seen Jannah
 - We reach this stage at different points for different things; someone who donates a lot will reach it quicker about donations being a means of increasing wealth vs someone who doesn’t donate at all

- A person on their deen only needs a reminder; they don't need convincing
 - *Example:* A kid on their 23rd juz will struggle towards the end of hifdh but that doesn't mean they need convincing it is important
- عين اليقين : Need to see it to believe it
 - For **munaafiqeen**
 - Kids see another kid touch a fire to believe it is dangerous
 - How the people of Gaza are for us
 - Some people learning about Islam or having doubts need a "why/how" answered. Allah will show us if it is out of a place of yaqeen, not challenging Allah
 - *Example:* Musa AS asked Allah to show him how He brings things back to life
 - Relying on this stage is a sign of lack of spiritual maturity
- حق اليقين : Need to experience it
 - For **disbelievers**
 - Kids will touch a fire because they don't believe it is dangerous

Surah Qariah

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 101

Order of Revelation: 30

Number of Ayahs: 11

Theme and Subject Matter: The Day of Judgment, book of deeds

Connection between Surah Qariah and Surah Zalzalah

- Surah Qariah and Zalzalah both speak about the ending

[1] "The Striking Calamity."

قرع : To knock, things hitting each other violently and making a disturbing noise

- الفارعة : Refers to a startling sound indicating the DOJ is beginning
 - Earth and sky hitting one another
 - Entire earth is halting in one moment; everything is leading its spot
 - The *taa marbuta* adds emphasis

[2] "What is the Striking Calamity?"

[3] "And what can make you know what the Striking Calamity is?"

- This type of questioning only works for big things
- "Do you know what dinner is?" - Yes, everyone already does

[4] "It is the Day when people will be dispersed like moths."

- People just moving about life with no purpose
- Literally talking about the DOJ with people dispersed all over

[5] "And the mountains will be like wool, fluffed up."

- Mountains moving is a sign of DOJ
- Why *عن wool?* → light and insignificant
 - Mountains are light for Allah
 - If mountains carry no weight, how will you?

[6] “Then as for those whose scales are heavy (with good deeds).”

- *3 conditions of a’mal being accepted*
 1. A person has eman
 - a. Disbelievers get their reward in this dunya
 2. *Hunafah*: People have to be sincere and have *istiqaamah*
 - a. It is easy to be sincere for a short amount of time
 3. Upon the *sunnah* of Prophet SAW
 - *إستخفاف* : Easily swayed; often by leaders in a community or celebrities; having no direction in life
 - The only thing that gives people *ثقل* - *heaviness* - is having a frame of reference that never changes →
- Quran**
- Imam Suyuti says sins don’t have weight; meaning one accepted a’mal is enough
 - Another opinion is that one good deed can outweigh all sins
 - What is the purpose of doing good if one deed might be enough?
 - We do not know what deeds carry the most *ثقل* and are sincere
 - We will naturally bank on some deeds more than others and that is okay; if you donate a lot, you will be more confident in that a’mal

[7] “He will have a pleasant life.”

- *عيشة* meaning life with no fear of food or shelter
- *راضية* - pleasant; mental state of contentment
 - Prime of everything of your being; beauty, strength, etc

[8] “But as for one whose scales are light.”

- If you are overexposed to a ni’mah in this life, you begin to get tired of it unlike Jannah
- Two opinions on if scales are literal scales; some say it is just a way of referring to the deeds being compared

[9] “His refuge will be an abyss.”

- Literally translated as, “Hell is his mother.”
 - They are running to Hell like a child to their mother because they are so happy to be done with the DOJ itself

[10] “And what can make you know what that is?”

[11] “It is a Fire, intensely hot.”

- Jahannum is always at its boiling point; never cools down

Final points

- The greatest sign of your a’mal being accepted is that Allah allows you to keep doing it
 - Sunnah of finishing a Quran is to begin again
- Da’wah is informing people and a means of getting more good deeds for yourself

- General goal of Jannah is ease
- Goal of Jahannum is that it will never get easier; you will not learn to tolerate the heat over time

Surah Adiyat

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 100

Order of Revelation: 14

Number of Ayahs: 11

Theme and Subject Matter: Ungratefulness of humans, warnings of the Hereafter, secrets hidden in the hearts

Connection between Surah Adiyat and Surah Takathur

- Similar themes; do not get distracted because you still have time

[1] "By the racers, panting."

- Parable of the Quran → Horses being used because Arabs valued them for their speed
- معتدين : Race past your boundaries; transgressors
- What is unique about these horses?
 1. They are rushing
 - a. ضيجا : Panting, struggling because of working hard
 2. They are running towards hard; listening to their owners even though it is self harm
 3. Blinders to avoid distractions by surroundings
- What does this imply?
 1. Very rare you can leave a sin if you slowly leave it
 - a. If Yusuf AS had slowly walked away, his shirt wouldn't have been ripped
 - b. Certain things you should not delay (salah)
 2. Even if the command of Allah was such that it "harm" you, you need to obey
 3. Focus
- You cannot be passionate without knowledge
 - In the US, we have ilm but lack passion. In reality, we also lack ilm

[2] "And the producers of sparks (when) striking."

- موريات : Hiding
- Fire hides things; burning evidence

[3] "And the chargers at dawn."

- Horses attack in the morning; believers should take advantage of morning barakah
- Whoever wakes up and the first thing they think of is that of dunya, their day will be difficult

[4] "Stirring up thereby dust."

- نقعا : Dust that would not rise without force
 - Abu Ubaydah said this means to elevate your voice; when dust is everywhere and you cannot be seen so you raise your voice to be heard
- غيرة : Dust that goes up because of wind
- هباء : Another word for dust

- This ayah transitions from nouns to verbs showing intensified actions
- أثر : Effect
 - Natural impact; feminine conjugation because of feminine horses
- ف : Immediately

[5] "Arriving thereby in the center collectively."

- وسطن : Penetrate through the middle
 - The nucleus of *kufr* being *shirk*
- جمعا : Altogether; worship is more rewarding in a group
 - A person who prefers always being alone will be in the *akhirah* alone

[6] "Indeed mankind, to his lord, is ungrateful."

- كنود : Extremely ungrateful
 - Another meaning is "someone who separates and disassociates"
 - Similar to how *munafiqeen* would leave the masjid except during spoils of battle distribution
 - Hasan RA says this is "someone who counts their calamities but forgets all their Lord's favors."
- هلوع : Always seeking people's remorse and sympathy
 - You enjoy being pitied; no solution in your comment
 - Example: Going to a janazah and saying, "Oh my mom died two years ago twins!"

[7] "And indeed, he is to that a witness."

- A witness against himself on the DOJ

[8] "And indeed, he is in love of wealth, intense."

- الخير : Literally means *good* but is referring to wealth
 - Why is this word being used instead of مال which means wealth?
 - Ibn Zaid says disbelievers will think of nothing but their wealth as good
- عافية : Health of body and heart

[9] "Do they not know what lies ahead in their grave?"

[10] "And that within the breasts is obtained."

- صدور is used in Surah Ikhlas as well

Surah Zalzalah

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkah and others say Madinan

Surah Number: 99

Order of Revelation: 93

Number of Ayahs: 8

Theme and Subject Matter: The end of time, life after death, the book of deeds

[1] "When the earth is shaken with its (final) earthquake."

- If the verb is being repeated in the noun form, it is the best way to emphasize

[2] "And the earth discharges its burdens."

- Because everything is shaken, it all leaves its original spot
- ثقل : Burden
 - Referring to humans; we are a burden on the earth
 - Allah only calls two creations ثقل - humans and jinns

[3] "And man says, "What is wrong with it?""

- Out of shock and fear, a person will be questioning "مالها," referring to the disbelievers
- Believers will not be surprised because they knew it was coming

[4] "That Day, it will report its news."

- Ibn Masood said the earth will literally speak to Allah to inform Him of our deeds

[5] "Because your Lord has commanded it."

- Inspiration has two words
 1. وحي : Wisdom and knowledge inspired
 - a. Recipient of *wahiyy* does not need to be a prophet (Ex: Musa's mother)
 2. إلهام : Action that is inspired

[6] "That Day, the people will depart separated (into categories) to be shown (the result of) their deeds."

- يصدر الناس : People come together/gather
- How on Hajj you form groups to feel safe because of chaos and sheer number of people
- When you are raised on DOJ, you will be with groups of people similar to you
- شئت : Grouping
 - You don't need to wait until *hisaab*; you will know your outcome the minute you see your group
 - Some say your deeds will take a physical form
- Two words for "deed" used in the Quran
 1. فعل : Action done without thinking about it
 2. عمل : Action done with intent

[7] "So whoever does an atom's weight of good will see it."

- متقال : Used to measure against each other
- ذرة : Dust particles, atm
 - Smallest thing imaginable
 - You will know the reward that came from one subhanAllah on Friday, Dec 12th at 1:45 am and it will result in more elation because you will feel like you did something to "deserve" it

[8] "And whoever does an atom's weight of evil will see it."

- و used vs previous ayah having ف used
 - If you know your gift is good, you will rush to open it. On DOJ, we will **want** to open our Book
 - و indicates not in a rush; not excited to see their Book but they have to

Surah Bayyinah

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Madinan

Surah Number: 98

Order of Revelation: 100

Theme and Subject Matter: What is the essence of revelation and its effects, the people of the book, idolaters, punishment and reward in the Hereafter

Connection between Surah Bayyinah and previous surahs

- Surah Alaq gives the command to "Read"
- Surah Qadr tells us when it was revealed
- Surah Bayyinah is taking it as a proof

[1] "Those who disbelieved among the People of the Scripture and the polytheists were not to be parted [from misbelief] until there came to them clear evidence."

- البينة comes from بيان : "clear speech"
 - Hyperbole of this word; nothing tops the idea of clear evidence more than this world
 - Being used for Quran, message, seerah alongside it
 - "If the Quran didn't come down, the mere existence and personality of the Prophet SAW is enough of a sign."
 - Each prophet had a proof relevant to the time and each nation was given miracles
 - What miracles were given to our ummah? → **Quran**
- يتلو : Acts on; doesn't mean the Prophet just read or memorized
- انفك : To be freed
 - You not believing in something does not remove the reality of it

[2] "A Messenger from Allah, reciting purified scriptures."

- Why is the Quran called مطهرة ?
 - The entire process is through *tahara*; you can only read it when you are pure

[3] "Containing upright commandments."

- قيمة means it makes them upright; not extreme but not inconsistent
 - Comes from قام : Standing up

[4] "Nor did those who were given the Scripture become divided until after there had come to them clear evidence."

[5] "And they were not commanded except to worship Allah, [being] sincere to Him in religion, inclining to truth, and to establish prayer and to give zakah. And that is the correct religion."

- حنفاء comes from *haneef*
 - Means *sincere* in defending of deen
 - Ibn Abbas says a *haneef* is someone who naturally turns towards right
 - Synonym of *ikhlas* but continuous
- قيم begins with understanding the *tawheed* of Allah

[6] "Indeed, they who disbelieved among the People of the Scripture and the polytheists will be in the fire of Hell, abiding eternally therein. Those are the worst of creatures."

- برية refers to all of humanity

[7] "Indeed, they who have believed and done righteous deeds - those are the best of creatures."

[8] "Their reward with Allah will be gardens of perpetual residence beneath which rivers flow, wherein they will abide forever, Allah being pleased with them and they with Him. That is for whoever has feared his Lord."

- أبدا : Forever
 - Allah uses it for believers but not kuffaar, showing His mercy
- جزاء : Proximity
 - Biggest reward for us in Jannah is proximity to Allah SWT

Surah Alaq

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 96

Order of Revelation: 1

Number of Ayahs: 18

Theme and Subject Matter: The first revelation, importance of knowledge, the threat against man's transgression for the sake of wealth

[1] "Recite in the name of your Lord who created."

- اقرأ : Recite; **not** read from a book
 - When the Prophet SAW responds "ما أنا بقارئ" it doesn't only imply that he was unlettered but also that these words are for sure not from him but a Higher Being
 - Prophet's revelation began with reading while Musa's began with listening
 - One of the first things that Waraqaah told the Prophet was, "This is the same angel that came to Musa."
 - Inception of both revelations was so similar
 - Imam Suyuti says they are connected. "First listen, then read."
- Why was the Prophet squeezed?
 1. Heart to heart; physical touch
 2. To show the Prophet what is to come with wahiyy; heaviness
 3. To cleanse the heart of the Prophet; like when you wring a wet towel
- Misconception that *Iqra* means education. It means to learn about your Lord from the beginning of every act:
 1. With name of Allah
 2. In the name of Allah
 3. With the help of Allah
- We learned iman before we learn fiqh; there is no belief in Allah without knowing who He is
- Disagreement about if the pen was the first creation. Ibn Katheer says four things could be:
 - Pen, water, 'Arsh of Allah, Jibril

[2] "Created man from a clinging substance."

- علق : To be attached
 - Referring to the blood clot we are created from
 - Allah is telling us how we came into existence

[3] "Recite, and your Lord is the most Generous."

[4] "Who taught by the pen."

[5] "Taught man that which he knew not."

- **مالم يعلم** everything including secular studies

[6] "No! [But] indeed, man transgresses."

[7] "Because he sees himself self-sufficient."

- **طَغَى** : To cross all boundaries
 - Once we think we know better is when we cross boundaries
 - Kids begin disrespecting parents when they think they know better
 - Same with Allah; we think we don't need Him the more independent we get

[8] "Indeed, to your Lord is the return."

- Just how we feel comfort going back to our mothers, we will feel comfort towards returning to Allah; death is a relief for the believers

[9] "Have you seen the one who forbids."

[10] "A servant when he prays?"

- Referring to three enemies of Allah: Abu Lahab, Abu Jahl and Waleed ibn Mugheerah
 - Didn't like Islam to be practiced publicly
 - Power of the truth is that it exposes falsehood
- **عبد** referring to the Prophet SAW

[11] "Have you seen if he is upon guidance"

[12] "Or enjoins righteousness?"

- Allah is asking "Did you even try to hear his message or did you just close your eyes?"

[13] "Have you seen if he denies and turns away?"

- **تولى** : To turn away

[14] "Does he not know that Allah sees?"

- 'Ulamah say this refers to Abu Jahl specifically

[15] "No! If he does not desist, We will surely drag him by the forelock"

- **الناصية** : Frontal lobe; where you make a decision from
 - Having a big forehead was a source of pride because it meant you were more intelligent
 - This is why *sajdah* is not complete if your forehead doesn't touch the ground; you are lowering the most honorable part of your body for Allah

[16] "A lying, sinning forelock"

- **خاطئة** means your brain is telling you not to deny the truth or to actively sin
- Evil acts are planned in your head before they are acted on by the body

[17] "Then let him call his associates"

- People become arrogant because of their followers
- Abu Jahl was referred to as Abu Hikm because people would go to him for advice

[18] "We will call the angels of Hell"

- **زبانية** : Names of harsh angels guarding Jahannum

- No ability to hear or speak; deaf to cries and pleas of people; feel no guilt for doing their job
- ز ب ن : To push, enforce → No possible way to retaliate to these angels

[19] “No! Do not obey him. But prostrate and draw near [to Allah].”

- As in “Do not obey those who prevent you from praying.”
- Right after this ayah was revealed, the Prophet fell into *sujood*
 - “Do sujood and you **will** draw closer to Allah” OR “Do sujood and **seek** closeness to Allah.” - Have the intention “I am doing this sajdah to become near to Allah.”
- Imam Ghazali says the purpose of salah is:
 1. راح : Comfort
 2. يعبدك : Protection; pushes away haram
 3. A person learns how to take from Allah’s treasures

Surah Qadr

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkah

Surah Number: 97

Order of Revelation: 25

Theme and Subject Matter: Importance and value of the Qur'an, the night of qadr

Background of this surah

- When Allah gifted the Prophet Surah Kawthar, he asked “What about my ummah?” That was when Allah said, “I gift them Laylatul Qadr.”

[1] “Verily We sent the Quran down during the Night of Decree.”

- قدر : To be precise in measurement
 - Allah’s perfection in everything He created
- قدرى : Ability/power
 - This is why Laylatul Qadr is called “Night of Power” - the ability to be precise is a sign of Allah’s strength/power
 - You can only be content with *qadr* if you know who put it there
- It is possible that this ayah means the first ayah was revealed on Laylatul Qadr
- Majority opinion is that it is referring to one of the three revelations of Quran
 1. ‘Ilm of Allah to *Lawhil-Mahfoodh*
 2. *Lawhil Mahfoodh* to *Bayt al Ma’moor*
 3. Gradual revelation to the prophet

[2] “What do you know about the Night of Power?”

- Appreciate it
- Why was it hidden? → To prevent laziness
- Laylatul Qadr is a set night that we look for in the odd nights

[3] “The Night of Decree is better than a thousand months”

- 1000 months = 83 years and 4 months; basically better than a lifetime of reward
- The only way to catch Laylatul Qadr is by treating all last ten nights with the same enthusiasm

[4] "The angels and the Spirit descend therein by permission of their Lord for every matter."

- روح : Jibril
- راح : Comfort
 - Allah is referring to Jibril as *Ruh* because he brought comfort to the Prophet
- The only night Jibril descends since the Quran came down is Laylatul Qadr

[5] "Peace it is until the emergence of dawn."

- The pause before سلام is the angels saying salaam to us
- 3 people whose dua goes straight to Allah
 1. Oppressed person
 2. A person in the path of Allah until they return home
 3. Parents who make dua from their heart

Final points

- Laylatul Qadr is the night Allah says to the angels, "This is why I created them." Just how we look at stars at night, angels look over earth and join wherever they see believers worshipping. Allah says to us, "If you could see what I see, you wouldn't get up from your spot."

Surah Duha

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 93

Order of Revelation: 11

Number of Ayahs: 11

Theme and Subject Matter: Allah reassuring the Prophet SAW, orphans, the blessings of Allah

Background of this surah

- *Wahiy* stops for a while; happens multiple times
 - Some say this happened one month after *Iqra*
 - Prophet became extremely overwhelmed and anxious
- This surah was revealed as a reassurance that Allah did not forsake the Prophet

[1] "By the morning brightness."

- Not the sunrise; rather the time of *ishraq* when the sun is just beginning to rise; it is easy and enjoyable to look at
- Why is *duha* used?
 - It was as if the Prophet was living in darkness before *wahiy* (most common tafseer)
 - Imam Suyuti says it is referring to the brightness of the Prophet's face
 - Most loving oath in the Quran; very personal. Ayah 2 is by the darkness of his hair
 - *Duha* is not where it ends; it is where it begins
 - In moments of difficulty, *duha* will come; implies Allah's help

[2] "And [by] the night when it covers with darkness."

- الليل means more of our life will be difficulty than ease; default is difficulty

- Allah could have said النهار because that is the opposite of *Layl* but He purposefully chose *Duha* because it is the best part
- Similar to ayah, "With difficulty comes ease."
 - Ease refers to akhirah; nothing will be "equivalent" to the hardship
 - Ceasefire is not the يسر - how would that be a fair ending to thousands of people killed?
 - It is simply a preview to the justice and reward of akhirah

[3] "Your Lord has not taken leave of you, [O Muhammad], nor has He detested."

- ماودعك : Forsaken, abandoned
 - ودع : Saying goodbye to someone you love who you don't want to say bye too
- "Your Lord has not bid you the farewell that is difficult to do; Allah does not **want** to leave the one He loves."
- Cause of discomfort for Prophet was not the words of people but rather distance from Allah
- Ibn Abbas, "If the surah ended at this ayah, the Prophet would be happy."
- Another tafseer: If Allah doesn't do وداع of the Prophet, how dare we?
 - For us, وداع is to forsake sunnah
 - "It's just *ghayr muakkadah*, I don't believe in miswak or x sunnah."
 - Faulty mentality → Even if a sunnah is "weak," keep your mouth shut
 - Don't do it if you don't want to but don't make it seem like you don't believe in sunnah altogether or make it seem like a weakness in another person for practicing
- وَمَا قَلَى : To detest
 - Allah doesn't even bother adding the pronoun because it isn't an option for the Prophet to be hated by Allah

[4] "And the Hereafter is better for you than the first [life]"

- *Akhirah* can mean afterlife or tomorrow
 - Every aspect of *akhirah* will be better
 - Any deficiency won't be present in *akhirah*
- Ali RA's tafseer, "Whoever's two days are exactly the same is the biggest loser."
- The only reason people in prison are surviving is because they are relying on being out soon; if you snatch away that hope, you have essentially snatched away their life
- Difficulty we have on relying on Allah's timing; anxiety arises when our timing doesn't "align" with the timing of Allah

[5] "And your Lord is going to give you, and you will be satisfied"

- سوف : Short term future; soon
 - Generally used to describe *akhirah*
 - Used for *dunya* of *kuffaar*, "Enjoy it now because that is all you will ever get."
 - Your comfort is soon ending
- سوف : Long term future; far away
 - When سوف is used in Quran for *akhirah*, it is used for believers because it will feel like a long time
- Opinion 1 Tafseer:
 - ترضى : *Fath-e-Makkah*
 - Waiting for over twenty years for this satisfaction
- Opinion 2 Tafseer:

- “You Lord is going to give you akhirah that makes you satisfied/”
 - The Prophet already knows whatever Allah gives him in akhirah will be satisfying
 - Some say this specifically refers to شفاع - ability to intercede
- Opinion 3 Tafseer:
 - سوف doesn’t mean later; it means continuously do something
 - “I will continue giving to you just as I am currently giving” → Badr, Fath, akhirah
 - When will the Prophet actually reach ترضى ? → During intercession on DOJ

[6] “Did He not find you an orphan and give [you] refuge?”

- In a society where orphans were so dishonored; even wet nurses didn’t want you initially
- مَأْوًى referring to مَأْوًى : “Homes”

[7] “And He found you lost and guided [you]”

- How was the Prophet ضَالًّا : Lost?
 - Why else would he go to Cave Hira?
 - Also the Prophet’s society was extremely confused and he was given light to guide them

[8] “And He found you poor and made [you] self-sufficient”

- عائل : Crushed under burden of these pressures; financially responsible
- Allah doesn’t do من to the Prophet; listing out the blessings
 - He isn’t humiliating the Prophet
- أَغْنَى is enough for Prophet to know, “Allah gave me x and y and so many ni’mahs”
 - People have غني in their pockets but فقر in their eyes; Prophet was the opposite

[9] “So as for the orphan, do not oppress [him]”

- Sahabah asked how to soften their hearts and the Prophet said to spend time with orphans

[10] “And as for the petitioner, do not repel [him]”

- فَلَا تَنْهَرْ means it is possible they ask you for something you don’t have
 - Allah is warning the Prophet from embarrassing and shunning these people; making them feel like a burden
 - The way you give matters more than what you give
 - Sh. Abdullah’s rule of not asking arrogant people for money even if they’re loaded because there is no barakah in money given out of spite

[11] “But as for the favor of your Lord, report [it]”

- حَدِّثْ : Speak of it
 - Let people benefit from it
 - What is the purpose of a ni’mah if it isn’t being used to help others?
- Why are you avoiding the orphan now if you were once one of them?
- Allah did not mention which favor
- He also didn’t even say نعم (all the favors); he said نعمة **one** favor
- Allah says, “Do they think they distribute Our blessings? We distribute it.”

Final points

- If you believe Allah doesn't love you, you lose all purpose and have nothing stopping you from sin; how will you feel comfort or strength knowing He is with you?

Surah Inshiraah

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 94

Order of Revelation: 12

Number of Ayahs: 8

Theme and Subject Matter: Ease after hardship, consolation for the Prophet

Background of this surah

- Surah Duha builds up to this surah; often read together because of similar themes
- Surah Duha ends with "Report the blessings of Allah."
 - Which raises the question, "Which blessing?"

[1] "Did We not expand for you (Oh Muhammad) your chest?"

- What does "expand your chest" imply?
 1. Open chest of Prophet to guidance and eman
 - a. A lot of times the mind accepts it but the heart doesn't
 2. Big heart with which we can have tolerance
 - a. Natural force will come against us when we share the truth
 3. Confidence in being a *da'ee* and in our beliefs
 - a. Most popular interpretation
- Allah gave it to the Prophet without him having to ask
 - حبيب of Allah
 - Musa was كليم of Allah, meaning he had to ask

[2] "And We removed from you your burden."

- Which burden? → The burden of people accepting his call
 - This weighed so heavily on mind of Prophet; he blamed himself for Quraysh not accepting Islam
 - وزر : Burden
 - وزير : Advisor, ambassador, supporter
 - OR "one who will never hold the burden of another" - as in the **sin** of another
 - What strings وزر and وزير together?
 - A وزير is someone who holds the burden of another
 - This is why the Prophet is being told he is free from burden of sins; so it doesn't weigh on him
- Another interpretation of ayah 2 is "And we removed from you your sins."
 - Righteous people are more affected by sins because they have higher standards for themselves

[3] "Which had weighed upon your back"

- نقض : To break
- "Back" is referring to "existence"
 - It burdened the Prophet in his existence; Allah is saying, "This burden shouldn't kill you."

[4] "And raised high for you your reputation"

- Ibrahim AS had to ask to be remembered by later generations (hence Durood-Ibrahim)
 - Durood Ibrahim is us replying to the salam of Ibrahim AS
- On the other hand, the Prophet didn't have to ask
 - Not اسمك - "We raised your name"
 - ذكرك - "We raised your remembrance/reputation"
- Anything that brings Prophet to our mind is raised in status
 - Sunnah, words, even us- the ummah of Rasool Allah
 - We remind others of the Prophet
 - The greatest legacy of Prophets is their ummah
 - We are the final ummah to arrive but the first to enter Jannah
 - **Not because of us** but because of our Prophet SAW being the greatest prophet
 - Hadith in Sunan Nasa'i about Prophet seeing all the nations of Prophets in *Mi'raaj*
 - "I will take pride if this is my ummah because of how many people there are."
 - "It is the ummah of Musa." - Then Allah shows Rasool Allah his ummah and it is seas of people never ending
 - Musa sees some of the fada'il of our ummah
 - "Ya Rabb, I see an ummah in the scriptures that can use water and dirt to purify themselves... Make them my ummah."
 - Allah replies, "This is the ummah of Ahmed."
 - Musa AS continues naming 7-8 fada'il of this ummah and Allah replies the same every time
 - Finally, Musa says, "Then make me a follower of Ahmed."
 - Every Prophet made this dua but only Esa AS's dua as accepted; he had his own nation but will also come back and follow our Prophet SAW
 - Sunnah is what elevates us; we do nothing for the sunnah
 - Benefits of *salawaat*
 1. Puts barakah in our rizq
 2. Reward of salawaat is higher than any other dhikr
 3. Brings barakah in our time

[5] "For indeed, with hardship [will be] ease"

[6] "Indeed, with hardship [will be] ease."

- العسر feels heavier because of the ال making it *marifa*
- اليسر feels like not as big of a deal because of it being *nakira*
 - We take time and health for granted
 - Sometimes duality is to show different types; *Jannataan* in Surah Rahman is not to show two separate Jannahs but rather various types of Jannah
 - Difficulty may come in different forms as well as ease
 - Not اليسر - "Complete ease"

[7] "So when you have finished [your duties], then stand up [for worship]"

- رغب : To really want something
- فرغب : "To make yourself free."
 - "When you get done with your communal responsibilities, here is a sense of contentment you cannot get from people."

- Your qiyam at night refuels you for the day; this is why our day begins at maghrib
- نصب : To struggle, exhaustion, difficulty
 - The same amount of effort you put in people, give it to Allah

[8] “And to your Lord direct [your] longing.”

- Coolness of Prophet’s life was salah; he found comfort in it

Final points

- How to develop رغب for Allah?
 1. معرفة : Know Allah; if you are ignorant towards something, you won’t love it
 2. Speak about Allah; the more you speak about something, the more you love it
 - a. Make it a sunnah to talk about Allah at least once a day
 3. Actually **do it**; talk to Allah and be in a state of deep love for Him
 - a. Develops over time
 - b. Don’t make loving what you are doing a condition to doing it

Surah Tin

Overview:

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 95

Order of Revelation: 28

Theme and Subject Matter: The creation of mankind, rise and decline of human beings, Day of Judgment

[1] “By the fig and the olive.”

- Oaths give that thing more importance. Why fig and olive?
 - No two figs are the same; similar to humans
 - Creation of figs is unique (ayah 4: “...As in awe of the creation of the fig you are, you are a creation more worthy of awe.”)
 - Olives have many benefits; similar to humans
- This ayah could also be highlighting fruits Allah love OR highlighting fruits the Prophet loves

[2] “By the Mount Sinai.”

- Reverence for Mount Tur because that is where Musa AS gets prophethood
- Uhud and Tur are two mountains of Jannah that Allah loves

[3] “And by this secure city” (Makkah)

- Makkah holds more virtue than Madinah in terms of ibaadah
- Highlighting the Prophet’s love for Makkah. He didn’t leave earlier because he wanted his own people to accept Islam more than anyone
- Prophet waited to be the last of *muhajireen* because he needed explicit permission from Allah
- The Prophet loves Makkah and Allah knew it; “We will change to a direction with which you will be pleased” without the prophet having to ask

[4] “We have certainly created humans in the best of stature.”

- Allah gave us the best physical state

- You might look at the moon and be amazed but angels look at us and are amazed
- Mufasireen look at every body part in this ayah's tafseer
 - Honorable way of walking
 - We eat with our hands unlike animals
- Value is not in our structure and how we look but rather **who** created us

[5] "Then We return him to the lowest of the low."

- Humans have the potential to be the best of creation but also the worst
- Similar concept to الرحمن الرحيم
 - *Ism tafdeel* with *ism faa'il*
 - Allah could have said "lowest" but He specified "lowest of the low."
- We lower ourselves because we didn't complete our function
 - What is the point of a beautiful car if it doesn't drive
- What is the function of a human being
 1. To worship
 2. To be ambassadors of Allah
 - a. Learning ilm and teaching
- Human beings have the potential but **not** as default; default is we are in the middle

[6] "Except for those who believe and do righteous deeds for they will have a reward uninterrupted."

[7] "So what causes you to deny the recompense?"

- We don't ask for Allah's عدل - we ask for His رحمة
 - We wouldn't make it to Jannah if we asked for His justice

[8] "Is Allah not the most Just of judges?"

- Why would we want anyone but Allah to judge us
- Allah will take the best of all our salahs and apply it to all our salahs
 - Struggle of human being is to find that salah
 - The moment we think we found it is when we should be worried

Exam in class mentioned:

- Focus on Surah Zalzalah, Adiyat, Qariah and Takathur and the connection between these surahs
- Also focus on Surah Alaq
- Less questions on Surah Bayyinah
- Surah Duha and Sharh will have less questions but more focus on vocab
- Potential questions:
 - Why is *Duha* used in comparison to *Wal layli wa ma sajaa*?
 - What does *fahaddith* mean?
 - *Ni'mah* comes from what?
 - From Surah Sharh, how can we derive that the Prophet is the greatest of all prophets?
 - *Wizr* of the Prophet?